Bodo Cultural Heritage: Bathra Phao (Bodo Proverbs)

Category: FOLKLORE | Region: Assam | Status: needs_check

Bibliographic Citation & Provenance:

Bodo Folk Literature & Oral Traditions (Bodo Sahitya Sabha)

Narrative & Cultural Documentation:

Bathra Phao (also known as Bathrasol) are traditional proverbs and folk aphorisms of the Bodo language that encapsulate community wisdom, moral ethics, agricultural insights, and human philosophy passed down across generations.

Prominent Bodo proverbs include: 1. "Hagramayao mwikhunw daosi, mansinao gwrbw khw bangsi" (Animals are known by their footprints; humans are known by the truth of their heart). 2. "Gongse bathrayao gwkha, gongse bathrayao gothao" (One word can be bitter as venom, another word sweet as nectar; speech carries profound consequence). 3. "Dwi bwhwilangba fangswla mwina" (Once river water flows past, the fishing weir cannot catch it; time and lost opportunities never return). 4. "Aia khwina, gothoa nwina" (The mother silently endures hardships, while the child sees only play and laughter). 5. "Mwsou gwdana haluwa jagwn, bwisagu gwdana haba jagwn" (The young calf grows into a steady plow-puller; the return of spring brings joyful marriages). 6. "Mansia janw ronga, sikhlaya danw ronga" (A man who cannot earn his bread and a woman who cannot weave on the loom find no honor). 7. "Dwi khw hwsonw hayo, barlangnaikhw hwsonw haya" (Flowing water can be banked, but a spoken word carried by the wind cannot be retrieved). 8. "Hasa khwsw, samphra gwkha" (Fertile soil yields sweetness through toil; untended weeds grow bitter on their own).